

Willie J. Washington III

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Dedicated Business Analyst/Product Owner with over 15 years of experience in developing and delivering high-quality, client-focused solutions. Recognized for strong analytical skills and the ability to translate complex requirements into actionable insights. A proactive leader with exceptional organizational abilities and a talent for multitasking. Known for effective communication, integrity, and a collaborative approach to driving business success.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Azure DevOps, Jira, Confluence, HP PPM, Scrum, Agile Frameworks, Lean Six Sigma, Requirements Gathering, Testing, Implementation, Use Case Creation, EDI Record Integration, Data Entry and Order Processing, Purchase Order Management, Executive-Level Reporting Development, KPI Definition and Development, Data Analytics, Quality Audits, Process Standardization and Simplification, User Story Development, Wireframe Creation, Functional Requirements Documentation

EXPERIENCE

RhemaCast., Chicago, IL — *Sr. Business Analyst*

November 2022 – Present

- Responsible for providing strategic business analysis services to key streaming application business partners.
- Lead information-gathering sessions to gain an in-depth understanding of customer business strategy, processes, services, and roadmap, with a focus on identifying and addressing operational and technological risks.
- Manage customer relationships and expectations by developing a communication process to keep stakeholders updated on project results.
- Provide leadership to team members and peers by fostering collaboration, articulating ideas and viewpoints across the organization, identifying and initiating projects, managing resources, driving issue resolution, and holding the team accountable for results.
- Produce project-level analysis documentation, including business requirements, scope matrix, use cases, sequence diagrams, future state proposals, and UAT plans using Azure DevOps.
- Collaborate closely with developers to implement requirements and provide guidance to testers during the QA process.
- Conduct technological research and evaluate vendor offerings to support project goals.

Blue Ridge Global., Atlanta, GA — *Sr. Business Analyst/Product Strategy & Product Owner*

May 2015 – September 2022

- Oversaw the development of products and features from inception to completion, ensuring alignment with client needs and preferences.
- Defined the overall vision of products and managed various backlog items to determine features based on client preferences.
- Analyzed enhancement requirements, conceptualized user design, wrote user stories, and collaborated with development and QA teams to implement new features and applications.

- Designed, developed, and delivered a standalone software application that was used by 80% of the company's clientele, generating 60% of all new business from a \$11B Food, Drink, and Tobacco giant.
- Collaborated with prospective users and clients to understand and anticipate their needs, translating them into clear product requirements.
- Set the strategy, created the product roadmap, and led cross-functional teams (UX, Engineering, Research) from conception through launch and multiple iterations.
- Tested and implemented cloud computing infrastructures to enhance product performance and scalability.
- Managed a multi-million-dollar initiative, successfully decreasing departmental backlog by 65% within one year using JIRA for managing and reporting Epics, bug fixes, and enhancements.
- Monitored projects and schedules, partnering closely with UX, development, and production teams to ensure on-time and on-budget completion.
- Defined and developed quantitative KPIs to track effective user adoption and the outcomes of features, functions, and capabilities, including establishing quantitative metric baselines.
- Developed complex user stories and wireframes for AI and machine learning-intensive products.
- Evaluated product progress at each stage of the development process, ensuring alignment with objectives.
- Liaised with the product team and end-users to deliver timely updates and gather feedback.
- Facilitated Scrum meetings and actively participated in product sprints to drive progress.
- Implemented quality and efficiency-based practices for overall improvement in QA and UAT testing.

AKQA., Atlanta, GA — *Sr. Business Analyst/Product Management*
November 2014 – January 2015

- Responsible for creating new and researching existing written requirements for several clients, including Lowe's and AutoTrader.
- Led cross-functional team meetings for multimedia creation, requirements definition, and iteration, demonstrating the ability to communicate feature benefits to executive officers and effectively prioritize business requirements for feature development.
- Participated in the development and delivery of sales proposals to potential clients, resulting in over \$5M in current and new business relationships.
- Facilitated in-person and virtual requirements-gathering sessions with internal and external departmental groups to ensure a comprehensive understanding of project needs.
- Monitored projects and schedules, partnering closely with UX, development, and production teams to ensure projects were completed on time and within budget.
- Defined and developed quantitative KPIs to track effective user adoption and the outcomes of features, functions, and capabilities, including establishing quantitative metric baselines.
- Elicited and documented detailed functional requirements for the conversion of a variety of e-commerce products and features.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams, including clients, to document functional requirements and process flows in an Agile environment.

Moxie Interactive., Atlanta, GA — Business Analyst – Documentation Specialist
June 2014 – August 2014

- Served in a client support role for Verizon Wireless, one of the world's biggest brands.
- Investigated and researched existing written requirements and process documentation, conducting gap analysis and Agile sessions for eCommerce platform upgrades and similar initiatives.
- Facilitated in-person and virtual requirements-gathering sessions with over 10 internal and external departmental groups for the largest project within the company.
- Elicited and documented detailed functional requirements for the conversion of a variety of e-commerce products and features to an ATG platform with an Endeca-driven search for a large telecom client.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams, including clients, external agencies, and internal eCRM and PMO team members, to document functional requirements and process flows in an Agile environment.

Assurant Specialty Property., Atlanta, GA — Business Unit Analyst
April 2009 – May 2014

- Served as a key support and operations resource within the Lender Placed Operations Department for the leading national provider of lender-placed hazard insurance.
- Delivered impeccable internal customer service and multifunctional non-routine problem-solving capabilities.
- Managed the EDI record integration of over 2 billion sensitive legal, regulatory, and customer data for the majority of top major and minor lending institutions in the U.S.
- Oversaw mission-critical initiatives that successfully decreased departmental backlog by 75%.
- Provided daily production support for multiple high-value clients, eliminating over 500 backlogged items through new process creation and collaborative group efforts.
- Led and facilitated waterfall sessions with key stakeholders for multiple high-priority clients to ensure alignment and progress.
- Designed and performed post-implementation quality audits to ensure proper execution and integrity of processes.
- Conducted interdepartmental project and status reporting, analyzing all records of processes and assessing their adherence to regulations and operating practices, while researching root causes and creating thorough reports for the executive team.
- Instructed personnel on the creation, implementation, and documentation of new systems to enhance operational efficiency.
- Resolved issues related to data integrity compliance and validation, conducting qualitative and quantitative research to support findings and ensure adherence to all regulatory requirements and best practices.
- Improved projects and processes by assessing existing forms and operational methods to develop enhancements through standardization, simplification, and/or discontinuance.
- Maintained alignment of projects with overall business objectives, making productive enhancement and modification recommendations that reinforced the company's mission and strategic goals.
- Reviewed system activity to ensure compliance with company policies, products, and services.
- Trained current team members, as well as new and temporary employees, on departmental best practices to promote consistency.
- Utilized HP PPM for project tracking, data analytics, and overall project insights across multiple departments.

Expeditors International of Washington Inc., Atlanta, GA — Order Management Expeditor
June 2008 – January 2009

- Responsible for the effective and efficient shipment and monitoring of ocean exports.
- Delivered impeccable customer service and real-time updates to ocean carriers and end customers, serving as a liaison for over 100 daily shipments to ensure proper execution and tracking of all booking, receiving, and shipping transactions.
- Managed web-based data entry and order processing to ensure accuracy and efficiency.
- Oversaw purchase order and vendor management, maintaining strong relationships to facilitate smooth operations.
- Developed and delivered executive-level reporting to provide insights into shipment performance and operational metrics.
- Implemented process improvements and ensured adherence to procedures and productivity standards to enhance overall efficiency.
- Conducted requirements gathering, test case creation, implementation, and issue resolution for external clientele to ensure satisfaction and operational success.

EDUCATION

DeVry University, Atlanta, GA.

Bachelor of Science in Business Administration

Magna Cum Laude

CERTIFICATIONS

Six Sigma Lean Professional and Change Management Specialist, November 2014

Certified SCRUM Master Certification (In Progress)